I had lost some thirteen pounds since going on a diet—but most of it went right back again on that trip.

I met Alfred Bester for the first time at that party, which was memorialized in the October 1952 issue of Galaxy. The cover painting of that issue included a number of the people at the party (including

Horace, though he couldn't attend since he couldn't leave his apartment). My face was included, but it had me holding a cocktail which, of course, I didn't do at that party.

The next day, Stanley visited us at the Blugermans', and he and I and John and Gertrude all went out on the traditional stroll along the boardwalk to Coney Island. Stanley, who is absolutely unflappable, went on the Ferris wheel with Gertrude. Nothing could have gotten me on it.

(Stanley was twenty-two at the time, the same age at which I had flunked the roller-coaster test with Gertrude. It was at about this time that he began his life's work. He joined the Long Island Newsday as a reporter and then proceeded to move up onto the editorial staff. Then, over the years to come, a steady gradation of promotions brought him to more and more responsible positions on the newspaper.)

On September 15, I collected some sales data. Howard Browne's Fantastic had taken another story of mine—"Sally"—about intelligent automobiles. (That story is one of my favorites.) Campbell was taking a second thiotimoline article I had written for him, "The Micro-psychiatric Applications of Thiotimoline" (how things had changed in the four years since the first one had appeared!), and Thrilling Wonder was taking "The Monkey's Finger."

The October 1952 Astounding contained the first part of The Currents of Space, with two more to follow. It was the third serial of mine that Campbell had published. When I had been in his office on the September trip, I had admired a painting there and asked which story it illustrated. Campbell laughed and said, "Yours," and now there it was, on the cover of the magazine.

I eventually bought the original for $25 plus postage. I framed it and it is still in my office today.

The November 1952 Galaxy included "The Martian Way," 6 which got the cover—with my name misspelled.